

5 · Bengal Partition, Swadeshi & Extremist Phase (1905-17)

SSC CGL Tier I · Modern History · keyword revision notes · Bengal Partition & Swadeshi → Moderates/Extremists split → revolutionary organisations & events → Muslim League & Morley-Minto → Home Rule & Lucknow Pact · appendix at end

Last-minute 12

1. **Bengal Partition (1905)** — proposed by Viceroy Curzon (1903), effective **16 Oct 1905**; official reason "administrative convenience"; real aim = weaken Bengal, the nationalist nerve-centre, via divide-and-rule; observed as a "Day of Mourning"; split East Bengal (Muslim, now Assam+Bangladesh) / West Bengal (Hindu)
2. Curzon's other reactionary acts: Calcutta Corporation Act (1899/1904, DOUBT), Official Secrets Act (1904), Indian Universities Act (1904/1905, DOUBT)
3. ★ **Swadeshi Movement** formally proclaimed **7 Aug 1905**, Calcutta Town Hall — boycott of foreign goods, championed at INC's 1905 Benaras session (Gokhale)
4. ★ **1907 Surat Split** — Congress splits Moderates (Gokhale; petitions/newspapers) vs Extremists (Lal-Bal-Pal + Aurobindo; direct action); president Rash Behari Ghosh; "Carrot and Stick" British strategy
5. **Lal-Bal-Pal**: Lala Lajpat Rai (Punjab) · ★ Bal Gangadhar Tilak ("Lokmanya," "Father of Indian Unrest"—Valentine Chirol; Kesari/Mahratta papers; Ganpati/Shivaji festivals; "Swaraj is my birthright"; Mandalay Jail 1908-14, wrote *Gita Rahasya*) · Bipin Chandra Pal (founded *Vande Mataram* journal)
6. ★ **Muslim League founded 30 Dec 1906, Dhaka** by Nawab Salimullah (+ Aga Khan per Parmar, DOUBT) — supported Partition, opposed Swadeshi, demanded separate electorate
7. **Morley-Minto Reforms/Indian Councils Act (1909)** — Morley (Sec. of State) + Minto (Viceroy, "Father of Communal Electorate"); introduced separate Muslim electorate; 1st Indian on Viceroy's Executive Council = Satyendra Prasad Sinha
8. Partition annulled at **3rd Delhi Durbar (1911, Hardinge II)**, for George V's coronation; capital shifted Calcutta→Delhi (1911)
9. Revolutionary orgs: Anushilan Samiti (1902, Bengal) → Jugantar Group (1906, Barindra Ghosh) · Abhinav Bharat (1904, Savarkar) · Ghadar Party (1913, San Francisco, Lala Hardayal/Sohan Singh Bhakna)
10. Alipore Bomb Case (1908) — Khudiram Bose & Prafulla Chaki, botched Kingsford attempt, killed Mrs Kennedy & daughter; Bose hanged; ★ Bhikaji Cama hoisted 1st Indian flag on foreign soil, Stuttgart 1907
11. **Home Rule League, 1916** — two leagues: Tilak's (Poona, first) & Besant's (Madras, more branches); renamed Swarajya Sabha (1920) after Tilak's death
12. **Lucknow Pact/Session 1916** (Ambika Charan Mazumdar) — INC+Muslim League pact, Congress

Key

TRAP easily confused pair

PYQ a real past SSC paper tested this — exact citation given

DOUBT sources conflict / unverified

★ tested in history_pyq.pdf (exam+date+shift in the appendix) · no personal attempt data exists for this book source, so there are no "my mistake" boxes anywhere in this build

1 Bengal Partition (1905)

Viceroy **Lord Curzon** proposed the partition (1903); announced July 1905; effective **16 Oct 1905**. Split: **East Bengal** (Muslim-majority; today Assam+Bangladesh) / **West Bengal** (Hindu-majority; today WB+Odisha+Bihar). Official reason: administrative convenience for a large, populous province. Real aim (both books agree): weaken Bengal's nationalist influence via **divide-and-rule**, creating a Hindu-Muslim communal gulf. Reaction: observed as a "Day of Mourning."

Curzon's reactionary policies bundled with the Partition: Calcutta Corporation Act (elected-Indian-seat cuts), Official Secrets Act 1904 (curbed press freedom), Indian Universities Act (tightened govt. control of universities).

	Bengal (1902-09)	E. Bengal & Assam
Area (km²)	366,692	275,938
Population (Mn)	54	31
Muslims (Mn / %)	9 / 16.67%	18 / 58.06%

DOUBT Curzon's act dates: Parmar — Calcutta Corporation Act 1899, Official Secrets Act 1904, Universities Act 1904; Lucent — Corporation Act 1904, Universities Act 1905. Not reconciled.

2 Swadeshi Movement & the 1905-07 Congress Sessions

- ★ **1905 Benaras** (Gokhale): approved Swadeshi/Anti-Partition; formal Swadeshi proclamation, **7 Aug 1905, Calcutta Town Hall**.
- 1906 Calcutta** (Naoroji): 4 resolutions — Swaraj (goal), Boycott, Swadeshi, National Education.
- ★ **1907 Surat** (Rash Behari Ghosh): Congress splits Moderates/Extremists over how far to extend the anti-Partition agitation. British "Carrot and Stick": appeased Moderates, suppressed Extremists (Tilak sent to Mandalay Jail 6 yrs; Aurobindo retired to Pondicherry; Lajpat Rai left for Britain).

2.1 Moderates vs Extremists

Moderates	Extremists (Lal-Bal-Pal + Aurobindo)
SN Banerjee, KK Mitra, GK Gokhale, Pherozeshah Mehta — methods: petitions, newspapers, pamphlets	Lala Lajpat Rai, Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Bipin Chandra Pal, Aurobindo Ghosh — methods: passive resistance, direct action, mass mobilisation, personal sacrifice

HOOK ★ **Tilak** one-box: "Lokmanya" · "Father of Indian Unrest" (Valentine Chirol, *Indian Unrest*) · papers *Kesari*(Marathi)/*Mahratta*(English) · Ganpati & Shivaji festivals · "Swaraj/Freedom is my birthright and I shall have it" · Mandalay Jail 1908-14, wrote *Gita Rahasya* there.

Muslim response: did not support the anti-Partition movement. ★ **All-India Muslim League founded 30 Dec 1906, Dhaka**, by **Nawab Khwaja Salimullah** (Parmar adds Aga Khan as co-founder — DOUBT, cross-ref Ch.9); supported Partition, opposed Swadeshi, demanded separate electorate.

HOOK Nationalist symbols of the period: Abanindranath Tagore's *Bharat Mata* painting (1905) · Rabindranath Tagore's *Amar Sonar Bangla* (now Bangladesh's national anthem) · Rakhi-tying for Hindu-Muslim/Bengal unity · *Vande Mataram* sung (later banned by govt.).

Newspapers of the anti-Partition period: *Hitabadi* (Dwijendranath Tagore), *Sanjibani* (Krishna Kumar Mitra), *Bengalee* (Surendranath Banerjee), *Bande Matram* journal (Bipin Chandra Pal). Regional leaders: Tilak (Poona/Bombay), Lajpat Rai (Punjab), Chidambaram Pillai (Madras).

3 Morley-Minto Reforms & Annulment of Partition

- Indian Councils Act 1909 / Morley-Minto Reforms** — Morley (Secretary of State), Minto (Viceroy, "Father of Communal Electorate"); introduced separate Muslim electorate; 1st Indian on the Viceroy's Executive Council: **Satyendra Prasad Sinha**.

- **3rd Delhi Durbar (1911, Lord Hardinge II)** — for George V's coronation; announced **reunification of Bengal**; capital shifted **Calcutta→Delhi, 1911**.

HOOK 3 Delhi Durbars: **1877** (Lytton, Victoria as Empress) · **1903** (Curzon, Edward VII's coronation) · **1911** (Hardinge II, George V's coronation + Bengal reunified + capital to Delhi).

4 Revolutionary Organisations, Events & Figures

Organisation	Year/Place	Founder(s)
Anushilan Samiti	1902, Bengal (Midnapur, Lucent)	Satish Chandra Basu, Jatindranath Banerjee, Pramathanath Mitra; Dacca branch 1907, Pulin Bihari Das
Jugantar Group	1906	Barindra Kumar Ghosh (split from Anushilan)
Mitra Mela → Abhinav Bharat	1899→1904, Poona	Savarkar Brothers
India House / Indian Sociologist	1905, London	Shyamji Krishna Verma
Ghadar Party	1913, San Francisco	Lala Hardayal, Sohan Singh Bhakna (1st President), Barkatullah, Kartar Singh
Berlin Committee	1915	Virendranath Chattopadhyay

4.1 Key events

- **1897**: Chapekar Brothers assassinated W.C. Rand (Plague Commissioner, Poona).
- **1908 Alipore/Muzaffarpur Bomb Case**: Khudiram Bose & Prafulla Chaki attempted to kill Judge Kingsford; killed Mrs Kennedy & daughter by mistake; Chaki shot himself, Bose hanged; Kanailal Dutta killed approver-witness Narendranath Goswami.
- **★1907, Stuttgart: Madam Bhikaji Cama** hoisted the first Indian flag on foreign soil (green/yellow/red, "Vande Mataram" inscribed) at the International Socialist Congress; smuggled into India by Indulal Yagnik; also published journal *Vande Mataram*, "Mother of the Indian Revolution."
- **1909**: Madan Lal Dhingra killed Curzon Wyllie (London); Anant Kanhere (Nasik, Lucent) killed District Magistrate Jackson.
- **1914**: Komagata Maru Incident — Japanese ship, 376 Indian (mostly Sikh) passengers denied entry to Canada.
- **1915**: Defence of India Act — suppressed Ghadarites in Punjab during WWI; later replaced by the Rowlatt Act (cross-ref Ch.6).

HOOK ★ **Bagha Jatin** (Jatindranath Mukherjee) — killed a tiger single-handedly; Yugantar party leader; led armed rebellion incl. the Indo-German Conspiracy; martyred in an encounter with British officers, 1915.

HOOK ★ **Rash Behari Bose** — founded Indian Independence League, Tokyo, 1942; key Ghadar-Movement figure; helped form the Azad Hind Fauj (INA), later handed command to Subhas Chandra Bose; awarded Japan's "Order of the Rising Sun" (2nd-highest civilian honour) — NOT independent India's first Army C-in-C (that was Field Marshal K.M. Cariappa).

World War I context (1914 onward): Moderates supported the war as duty; Extremists supported it hoping for post-war self-governance; Revolutionaries saw it as an opportunity for armed struggle. Allies: Britain, France, Russia, Italy, Japan, USA, Belgium. Central Powers: Germany, Austria-Hungary, Ottoman Empire, Bulgaria.

5 Home Rule League (1916) & Lucknow Pact

Bal Gangadhar Tilak's HRL	Annie Besant's HRL
HQ Poona; founded first (28 Apr 1916); Centre: Maharashtra(excl. Bombay City)/Karnataka/Central Provinces/Berar	HQ Madras; more branches; started Sept 1916 (inspired by the Irish Home Rule movement); Centre: Madras & Bombay City

After Tilak's death (1920), his HRL renamed **Swarajya Sabha** by Gandhi.

Lucknow Session, 1916 (Ambika Charan Mazumdar): reunion of Moderates & Extremists; **Lucknow Pact** — INC+Muslim League joint platform (via Tilak's & Jinnah's efforts); Congress accepted separate electorate; joint demand for "dominion status." INC's own demands: self-government, abolish India Council, separate judiciary/executive, Secretary of State's salary off the Indian treasury, half the Executive Council Indian, 1/3rd Muslim representation.

HOOK Writings: *New India & Common Weal* (Annie Besant) · *Al Hilal* (Urdu weekly, Maulana Abul Kalam Azad, also wrote *India Wins Freedom*) · *Comrade* (Maulana Mohammad Ali).

Montagu/August Declaration, 1917 (Lucent) — British policy response to Hindu-Muslim unity at Lucknow: gradual transfer of government control to Indians, gradual development of local self-government.

A Appendix

A.1 PYQ citations — every ★ fact in this chapter

Fact tested	Exam citation	Answer
Reason British govt. decided to partition Bengal (1905)	SSC CPO TIER-I, 11/12/2025 (Shift-01)	Weaken nationalism/divide-and-rule (official reason: admin. efficiency)
Viceroy under whom Bengal Partition (1905) was carried out	SSC PHASE XIII, 30/07/2025 (Shift-01)	Lord Curzon
V.O. Chidambaram Pillai's Swadeshi enterprise	SSC CGL TIER-I, 22/09/2025 (Shift-03)	Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company
Who hoisted the first Indian flag on foreign soil, Stuttgart 1907	SSC CGL TIER-I, 22/09/2025 (Shift-01)	Madam Bhikaji Cama
Barindra Kumar Ghosh, Abhinash Bhattacharya, Bhupendranath Dutta's movement, March 1906	SSC Stenographer, 08/08/2025 (Shift-02)	Swadeshi movement (founded the newspaper <i>Yugantar</i> , 1906)
Anushilan group's allegiance after the Bengal Congress split (post-C.R. Das death)	SSC Stenographer, 07/08/2025 (Shift-03)	J.M. Sengupta's faction (the <i>Yugantar</i> group joined Subhas Bose)
Bagha Jatin's identity/role	(same bucket, exam citation not separately captured in extraction)	Led <i>Yugantar</i> /Indo-German Conspiracy, martyred 1915
Statement NOT true about Rash Behari Bose	SSC Stenographer, 06/08/2025 (Shift-02)	He was NOT independent India's first Army C-in-C (that was K.M. Cariappa)

One question from this cluster (Baikuntha Shukla killing government approver Phanindra Nath Ghosh in the Lahore Conspiracy Case, SSC CGL TIER-I 20/09/2025 Shift-01) belongs chronologically to the Civil Disobedience/Simon Commission era, not this chapter's 1905–17 scope — cross-referenced forward to Ch.7, not built here.

A.2 New facts sourced only from the PYQ book (not in Parmar or Lucent)

None found this batch beyond minor explanatory colour (e.g. Rash Behari Bose's Tokyo League date, "1942," and the Order of the Rising Sun detail) which is already implicit in the raw extraction's revolutionary tables; no wholly new fact needed adding.

A.3 Cross-book & cross-source doubts carried forward

- **Muslim League's 1906 founder(s):** Parmar names Nawab Khwaja Salimullah *and* Aga Khan; Lucent names Salimullah alone. Not reconciled (cross-ref Ch.9 for the further Aga-Khan citation in Parmar's viceroy chapter).
- **Curzon-era act dates** (Corporation Act 1899/1904; Universities Act 1904/1905) — see §1 DOUBT box.
- **Two distinct "Vande/Bande Mataram" journals:** Bipin Chandra Pal's *Bande Matram* (Parmar) vs Bhikaji Cama's *Vande Mataram* (also Parmar/Lucent) — different publications with near-identical names, not merged.
- **Two "Anushilan Samiti" entries** (Midnapur 1902 vs Dacca 1907, different founders) — kept distinct per the raw extraction's own flag.

- **Home Rule League dates:** Lucent's own section heading says "(1915-16)" while its body text dates both leagues to 1916 — an internal Lucent inconsistency, not a cross-book one.

A.4 Completeness check

Every fact in `bengal_partition_swadeshi_extremists_raw_extraction.md` Parts A & B (incl. the Lucent addendum's revolutionary-organisation/event tables) is represented above except: the full "Other Extremist Leaders" name list (Raghvachariar, Aswini Kumar Dutta, Raj Narayan Bose, T. Prakasham) and the later-era revolutionary events (Kakori 1925, Saunders murder 1928, Assembly Bomb 1929, Chittagong 1930, O'Dwyer 1940) — these post-date this chapter's 1905–17 scope and are cross-referenced to Ch.7 (Civil Disobedience & Simon Commission), which is where Parmar's own later revolutionary timeline continues, rather than repeated here.